

Sehar Khan

Cybersecurity Analyst · SOC · Incident Response · Cloud Security

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Professional Summary

Multidisciplinary professional transitioning into cybersecurity, bringing a unique foundation in software engineering, quality assurance, and visual communication into security operations and defensive engineering. Hands-on experience across 75+ NIST/NICE-aligned labs at NJIT covering incident response, SIEM analysis, threat hunting, and penetration testing. Founder of BlueSentinel (Linux NGFW + SOC dashboard) and CyberConfigs (security consultancy). CyberAdvantage and IR Expert certified; Certified Ethical Hacker (CEH) and Cisco CCNA in progress.

Technical Skills

Security Operations: SIEM, Snort IDS, Incident Response, Threat Hunting, Digital Forensics, Malware Analysis, IOC Identification, MITRE ATT&CK

Offensive Security: Penetration Testing, Ethical Hacking, Vulnerability Assessment, Nmap, Metasploit, Burp Suite, Nessus, Hydra, Wireshark, Kali Linux

Cloud & Identity: AWS IAM / VPC / EC2 / S3, Azure AD, RBAC, Conditional Access, OAuth 2.0, OpenID Connect, MFA, Least-Privilege Design

Network & Systems: Cisco IOS, NAT / PAT, Port Security, nftables / iptables, Linux Hardening, Packet Tracer, DNS Security

Frameworks: NIST CSF, NICE, OWASP Top 10

Dev & Tools: Python, FastAPI, React, Docker, CI/CD, Git, Nginx, Flutter / Dart

Experience

Founder & NGFW / SOC Platform Engineer

BlueSentinel (bluesentinel.ai) — Self-employed

- Architected a full-stack security operations platform: React SOC dashboard, FastAPI backend, and Nginx reverse proxy on hardened Linux.
- Engineered a Linux-based NGFW using nftables and ClamAV with stateful packet inspection, SYN flood / DoS mitigation, and automated threat quarantine.
- Built a real-time log ingestion pipeline for SIEM-style alert triage and threat-intel visualization across network and endpoint sources.
- Documented architecture to NIST and OWASP standards; implemented IAM, RBAC, and API-level access controls for scalable cloud deployment.

Cybersecurity Analyst — Graduate Labs

New Jersey Institute of Technology — Newark, NJ

- Completed the NJIT x IronCircle Cybersecurity Bootcamp spanning 76+ NIST/NICE labs in Network Operations, Systems Administration, Exploitation Analysis, Defensive Cybersecurity, Digital Forensics, and Incident Response.
- Performed end-to-end incident investigations, threat hunting, SIEM analysis, digital forensics, malware analysis, and vulnerability assessments using Splunk, Security Onion, Snort, Nmap, Metasploit, Burp Suite, Nessus, and Wireshark.
- Configured Cisco devices implementing port security, Static / Dynamic NAT, and NAT Overload; verified topologies through 13 Packet Tracer simulations.
- Authored structured incident response and pentest reports aligned to NIST and OWASP frameworks.

Cloud Security Engineer — AWS & Azure Labs

New Jersey Institute of Technology — Newark, NJ

- Configured AWS IAM, VPC security groups, EC2, and S3 access controls applying least-privilege and policy-simulation principles.
- Implemented Azure AD, RBAC, NSGs, Conditional Access, and MFA; deployed identity governance and federation via OAuth 2.0 / OpenID Connect.
- Deployed Docker containers through CI/CD pipelines integrated with cloud-native monitoring and logging for security visibility.

Software Quality Engineer

Upwork & Fiverr — Remote

- Performed security-aware black-box, manual, regression, exploratory, and automation testing for web and mobile applications.
- Identified input-validation flaws and edge-case behaviors that introduced potential security risks; conducted root-cause analysis on application failures.
- Created detailed test plans, test cases, and Requirement Traceability Matrices (RTMs); delivered structured defect reports across full Agile release cycles.

Operations & Technical Support Manager

Omega Diner & Cafe / AA Diner — New Jersey, USA

- Led a team of 25+ staff; managed scheduling, compliance, vendor relationships, and operational reporting.
- Provided deskside and remote technical support for POS systems, payment terminals, and business software; resolved hardware, network, and connectivity incidents.
- Enforced controlled system access and procedural security compliance; escalated critical incidents to vendors with documented timelines.

Projects

BlueSentinel — Linux NGFW + SOC Dashboard

nftables, ClamAV, FastAPI, React, Nginx, Docker

- Self-built next-gen firewall with real-time SIEM-style monitoring, automated threat response, and a React-based analyst dashboard.
- Implemented stateful packet inspection, SYN flood mitigation, and quarantine workflows; documented to NIST and OWASP guidance.

Pi-Hole DNS Sinkhole + Cross-Platform Mobile Client

Linux, iptables, Pi-Hole, Flutter, Dart

- Deployed a hardened Pi-Hole on a virtualized Linux host with default-DROP iptables policy and 7+ rules (DNS, DHCP, SSH).
- Resolved DNS, SSL, and dependency conflicts; began Flutter / Dart mobile client for remote administration via the Pi-Hole API.

CyberConfigs — Public Security Configuration Library

Kali Linux, Burp Suite, Metasploit, Nmap

- Founded and maintained an open repository of hardened configurations, defensive tooling, and CTF write-ups.

Certifications

- CyberAdvantage — IronCircle
- IR Expert (Incident Response) — IronCircle
- Cyber Security 101 — TryHackMe
- Pre-Security — TryHackMe
- Certified Ethical Hacker (CEH) — In progress
- Cisco CCST / CCNA — In progress

Education

New Jersey Institute of Technology

Cybersecurity Graduate Program — Newark, NJ

Hunerkada College of Visual & Performing Arts

Associate's Degree, Visual & Performing Arts — Islamabad, PK

Iqra National University

Associate's Degree, Software Engineering — Pakistan

University of Peshawar

B.A. Art & Design — Visual Communication & Photography (Grade: A) — Peshawar, PK